

Are You in Love or Pride?

Consider the qualities of LOVE listed in 1 Corinthians 13 and compare them with the evidence of your own life. Love is the antidote to the pride system, which is full of illusions, claims, shoulds, self-hate, and fear.

Love is **makrothumos** – is long-tempered, magnanimous, tranquil and principled under pressure

Love is **kind** – does kindnesses, initiates productive good toward others and self

Love is **not envious** – does not believe that life is unfair or that it should have what another has

Love does **not vaunt itself** – is not egocentric, asserting its own interests over or onto others

Love is **not puffed up** – does not believe that it is superior and entitled

Love is **not rude** – does not sacrifice others to meet its need for vindictive triumph

Love does **not seek its own** – does not focus on and impose its own interests, standards, and desires

Love is **not provoked** – does not react destructively to frustration

Love does **not reckon the evil** – does not use past harm to justify present behavior

Love does **not rejoice over wrong** – does not judge others in order to feel vindictive triumph

Love **rejoices in the truth** – joyfully embraces real evidence about the self, the Creation, and God

Love **covers all things** – smooths over another's misorientation with active goodness

Love **believes all things** – trusts and acts upon what it has learned about the Creation, self, and God

Love **hopes all things** – uses the imagination to envision healthy possibilities

Love **endures all things** – goes through the laborious process of change

Love **never fails** – becomes the default choice; it always supports orientation and real self-confidence